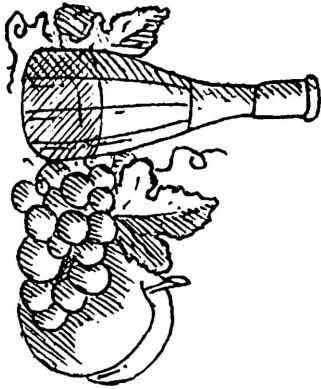




Вино од Шљива (Vino od Šljiva) Rakiya Wine: How to Make this Balkan Beverage at Home Van Houten Family Recipe

- Equipment:**
- 1/2 Gal. Carboy
 - Airlock
 - Stockpot
 - Potato Masher
 - Thermometer
 - Spoon
 - Paper towels
 - Sieve

- Ingredients:**
- 2 1/2 lbs ripe plums
 - 1 1/2 lbs sugar
 - 8 C water
 - 1 tsp lemon juice
 - 1 pkt champagne yeast
- Setup:**
- Sanitization:**
- The most important step. Everything must be sanitized by soaping the item(s) & then pouring boiling water (an electric kettle works well) over & in the item(s). To prevent breaking glass, temper with hot water. This shall be referred to as "sanitizing".

- Method:**
- Sanitize all equipment.
 - Wash plums; remove stems & stones. Mash & bruise.
 - Add water to pot & boil.
 - Take off heat & add plums.
 - Cover with paper towels & tie with string; Rest 24h.
 - Add lemon juice & sugar. Stir. Follow instructions on yeast & add. Stir again.
 - Retie towel. Let rest, stirring daily. Fruit and yeast should drop to the bottom. When this occurs or 1 week passes, continue.
 - Sanitize carboy. Siphon or strain liquid into it, leaving behind all sediment (makes bad flavor). Install airlock. Rest until bubbling stops. If it separates into layers, keep liquids and throw away solids, placing the liquid back in the jug, and continuing until bubbling ceases.

- Post Fermentation:**
- Pasteurization (Optional):**
- Put all the wine into wine bottles and cover the tops with tin foil. Place all of the bottles into the stock pot with a cloth napkin on the bottom, and fill with water to the necks. Heat until the temperature of the liquid inside the bottles reaches 169 °F for 15 seconds. Let cool.
- Storage:**
- Store wine in a cool, dark place, away from direct sunlight and temperature fluctuations, to prevent spoilage and maintain its flavor profile. Fill bottles to the top of the shoulders. Ensure bottles are tightly sealed to prevent oxidation, and label with the date of production to keep track of aging and flavor development over time.

- Modifications:**
- Resting improves flavors. If the wine dries too dry, add sugar*. (ex. Splenda). The traditional Van Houten recipe used more aged and re-fermented with new yeast to achieve a higher ABV. See below for more modifications:
- Вино од Шљива (Vino od Šljiva): No mods.
- Ракџија (Rakiya): May be imitated by adding vodka to the wine.
- Траварџија (Travarica): Steeped with herbs. Common options include mint, chamomile, rosemary, lemon balm, & anise. Herbs can be macerated for several days to months. Use teabags for a cheap & easy Travarica.
- Медиџа (Medica): Steeped with honey*.
- *Do not add more sugar unless one will pasteurize the wine, due to exploding bottles.

- Troubleshooting:**
- Fermentation Stall:**
- Check & fix temp. Else add more yeast.
- Off Odors or Flavors:**
- Can result from contamination or poor sanitation. If smell is sulfur / rotten egg gently aerate the wine.
- Cloudy Wine:**
- Results from suspended particles or yeast. Rack properly or add chemicals.
- Low Alcohol Content:**
- Add more sugar.
- Excessive Sediment:**
- Rack properly, and strain. Consider cold crashing if necessary.
- Unpleasant Aftertaste:**
- Unknown origin. could be poor-quality fruit, yeast choice, or fermentation issues.
- Mold:**
- Throw it out.
- Too Dry:**
- Add sugar/honey if pasteurized or substitute.
- Unhealthy Yeast:**
- Add boiled bakers yeast, black tea, & raisins.
- Bitter:**
- Was kept in contact with plum skins for too long.
- Sour:**
- Throw it out.
- Insufficient Aging:**
- Wine has a harsh or unbalanced taste. Age longer & consider modifications.
- Gas Buildup in Bottles:**
- Was bottled before fermentation finished. Pasteurize or finish fermentation.